



## Prepare for the Q&A

A question-and-answer session, or Q&A, is a valuable opportunity for stakeholders and audience members to ask you any questions they might have about your findings. They can be challenging because you don't always know what to expect, they require purposeful listening, and it's challenging to keep everyone involved. So, in this part of the course, you will discover some best practices to help you master the Q&A.

In this reading, you will work on the first step: preparing questions to ask before planning your data gathering and presentation. There are many things to consider before you begin asking and answering possible questions—including the objective, stakeholder expectations, and if there are any limitations. Make sure you have everything covered before you begin. The checklist below identifies 10 tasks that you should engage in to be prepared for your Q&A:

### **Before the presentation**

1. Assemble and prepare your questions.
2. Discuss your presentation with your manager, other analysts, or other friendly contacts in your organization.
3. Ask a manager or other analysts what sort of questions were normally asked by your specific audience in the past.
4. Seek comments, feedback, and questions on the deck or the document of your analysis.
5. At least 24 hours ahead of the presentation, try and brainstorm tricky questions or unclear parts you may come across- this helps avoid surprises.

6. It never hurts to practice what you will be presenting, to account for any missing information or simply to calm your nerves.

## During the presentation

1. Be prepared to respond to the things that you find and effectively and accurately explain your findings.
2. Address potential questions that may come up.
3. Avoid having a single question derail a presentation and propose following-up offline.
4. Put supplementary visualizations and content in the appendix to help answer questions.



## Practice makes perfect

Preparing for a presentation or a meeting doesn't have to be intimidating. If you invest time into knowing your audience, crafting your notes, doing necessary research and organizing your data, then there is very little reason why your audience will not be engaged, even impressed.